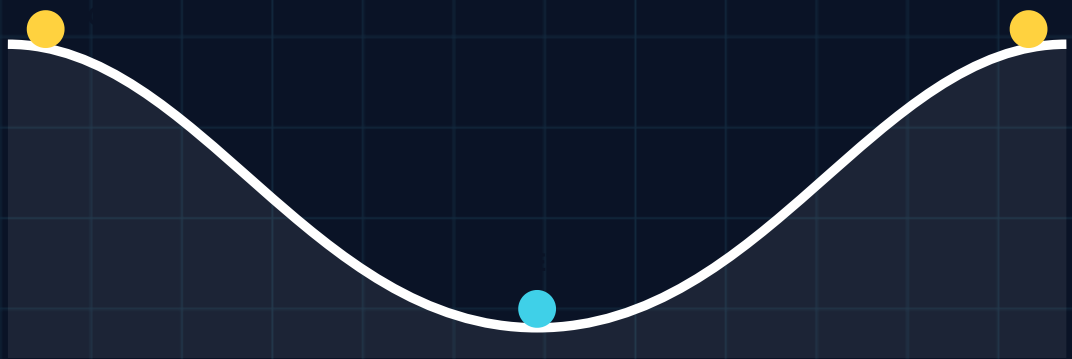
YEAR 9 PHYSICS, AQA GCSE, UNIT 2

ENERGY STORES AND TRANSFERS

Where energy is stored, how it moves, how fast it moves and how much of it is useful: nine lessons, from your first energy store to confident exam answers.

9 LESSONS **6** PRACTICALS **8** EQUATIONS

ANSWER EDITION FOR TEACHERS AND SELF-MARKING



NAME _____ CLASS _____

TEACHER _____ TARGET GRADE _____

START HERE

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

Energy is never made and never destroyed: it only moves from one store to another. This booklet shows you how to follow it, and how to calculate it. Keep the booklet: it is your classwork book *and* your revision guide.

DO NOW
Quick questions from earlier lessons. Remembering again is what makes it stick.

LEARN IT
The explanation, diagrams and worked examples. Read this again when you revise.

TRY IT
Practice that builds up: first with support, then on your own.

PRACTICAL
Record your measurements and work out results from them.

EXAM CORNER
AQA-style questions with a tip on how the marks are given.

REVISE IT
Summary, cover-and-answer questions and an "I can" check to colour in.

! **Two kinds of question to know.** When a sentence has a gap, the choices are printed straight after it, like this: Energy is measured in ___joules___ **(joules / newtons / watts)**. When you see a box of choices, **draw a ring around** the correct one, as AQA exam papers ask. The unit of energy is **the watt** | **the joule** | **the newton** .

THE ROUTE THROUGH THE UNIT

#	LESSON	WEEK
01	**Energy stores and systems** The energy stores, four ways to transfer energy, systems	1
02	**The kinetic store** $E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$; grams to kilograms; double the speed, four times the energy	1
03	**The gravitational potential store** What g means, $E_p = m g h$, height gained, finding h or m	2
04	**Stretching springs** Two forces, elastic and inelastic, extension, $F = k e$, two graphs	2
05	**The elastic potential store** $E_e = \frac{1}{2} k e^2$; two-step questions; double the stretch, four times the energy	3
06	**Conservation of energy** Closed systems, falling and swinging, energy bar charts, dissipation	3
07	**Power** Power as a rate, watts, $P = \frac{E}{t}$, how powerful are you?	4

#	LESSON	WEEK
08	**Wasted energy** Dissipation, lubrication, thermal conductivity, insulation, design an Eco House	4
09	**Efficiency** Efficiency from energy or power, decimals and percentages, Sankey diagrams	5

The **equation toolkit** on the last page has every equation in the unit, with formula triangles to help you rearrange.

Lesson

01 ENERGY STORES AND SYSTEMS

AQA Physics 4.1.1.1; Combined Science 6.1.1.1

BIG QUESTION **A skateboarder rolls down one side of a ramp and up the other, but never quite gets back to the starting height. Where did the energy go?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- name the energy stores and give an example of each
- name the four ways energy is transferred
- explain what a system is
- describe the energy transfers when something changes

energy store **transfer** **system** **closed system** **joule (J)**

YOU WILL NEED

This booklet, a pencil and a ruler.

REMEMBER

WHAT DO YOU ALREADY THINK?

No wrong answers: this is your starting point.

1

Name something that has energy. How can you tell?

For example, a moving car (it is moving) or a hot drink (it is hot). Any sensible answer.

2

Energy is measured in **joules** **(joules / newtons / metres)**.

joules (J)

3

Rub your hands together. They get **warmer** **(warmer / colder)**. Why?

Warmer: rubbing (friction) transfers energy to the thermal store of your hands.

EXPLAIN

STORES AND TRANSFERS

Energy is never made and never used up. It is **stored**, and it is **transferred** (moved) from one store to another. Energy is measured in **joules (J)**.

THE FIVE MAIN ENERGY STORES

STORE	ENERGY IS STORED BECAUSE…	EXAMPLE
Kinetic	the object is moving	a rolling football
Gravitational potential	the object is raised up	a book on a high shelf
Elastic potential	the object is stretched or squashed	a stretched spring, a drawn bow
Thermal	the object is hot	a cup of tea
Chemical	of the substances it is made of	food, fuel, a battery

You may also meet the **magnetic** store (two magnets held apart), the **electrostatic** store (a charged balloon) and the **nuclear** store (uranium fuel), but GCSE questions rarely use them.

FOUR WAYS TO TRANSFER ENERGY

TRANSFERRED…	WHAT HAPPENS	EXAMPLE
mechanically	a force moves something	pushing a trolley
electrically	a current flows	a battery lighting a lamp
by heating	a hotter object warms a colder one	a hob heating a pan
by waves	a wave carries it: light, infrared (both called radiation) or sound	the Sun warming your face; a loudspeaker

! **Stores hold energy. Transfers move it.** Light, sound and electricity are **not** stores: they are ways energy travels from one store to another.

SYSTEMS

A **system** is the object, or group of objects, that we choose to study. In a **closed system**, no energy gets in or out, so the **total** energy stays the same. The energy only moves between stores.

DESCRIBE ANY CHANGE IN THREE STEPS

1. Which store **empties**?
2. Which store **fills**?
3. **How** is the energy transferred: mechanically, electrically, by heating or by waves?

EXAMPLE: A CAR BRAKING

The kinetic store of the car empties. The thermal store of the brakes fills. Friction is a force, so the energy is transferred mechanically. **Write:** "Energy is transferred mechanically from the kinetic store of the car to the thermal store of the brakes."

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a line from each store to its example.

Kinetic	a rolling ball
Gravitational potential	a book on a high shelf
Elastic potential	a stretched bow
Chemical	a battery
Thermal	a hot bath

2 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

Light is **an energy store** / **a way energy is transferred**

A battery stores energy in its **chemical store** / **kinetic store** / **thermal store**

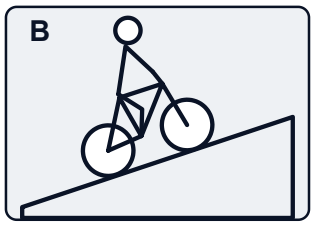
At the top of its flight, a ball has most energy in its

kinetic store / **gravitational potential store**

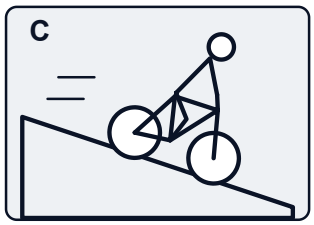
3 The pictures tell a story. For each picture, write the store that **empties** and the store that **fills**. Choose from the words under each gap.



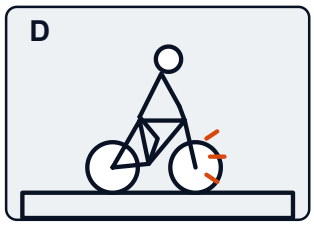
Eating breakfast



Cycling up the hill



Freewheeling down



Braking at the bottom

PICTURE	STORE THAT EMPTIES	STORE THAT FILLS
A Eating	chemical (in the food)	chemical (in the body)
B Cycling up	chemical / kinetic **chemical (body)**	gravitational potential / elastic potential **gravitational potential (and thermal)**
C Freewheeling down	gravitational potential / chemical **gravitational potential**	kinetic / nuclear **kinetic**
D Braking	kinetic / thermal **kinetic**	thermal / chemical **thermal (brakes and surroundings)**

4 SUPPORTED Complete each sentence. The choices are after each gap.

A ball is thrown upwards. Energy is transferred from the **kinetic** **(kinetic / chemical)** store to the **gravitational potential** **(gravitational potential / thermal)** store.

A fireplace warms a person. Energy is transferred by infrared waves from the **chemical** **(chemical / kinetic)** store of the fuel to the **thermal** **(thermal / kinetic)** store of the person.

A child lands on a trampoline. Energy is transferred mechanically from the child's **kinetic** **(kinetic / chemical)** store to the trampoline's **elastic potential** **(elastic potential / thermal)** store.

5 ON YOUR OWN A bungee jumper falls, and the cord stretches until the jumper stops at the bottom. Describe the energy transfers. Use the three steps.

As the jumper falls, energy is transferred from the gravitational potential store of the jumper to the kinetic store. As the cord stretches, energy is transferred from the kinetic store to the elastic potential store of the cord.

6 Explain what is wrong with what Sam says.

Sam: When the car stopped, its energy was used up.

Energy cannot be used up (destroyed). The energy in the car's kinetic store was transferred to the thermal store of the brakes and the surroundings.

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

Get the marks: Name both stores and say which one empties and which one fills.

7 A student throws a ball straight up. Complete the sentence. **[2 marks]**

As the ball rises, energy is transferred from the **kinetic** **(kinetic / chemical / thermal)** store of the ball to its **gravitational potential** **(elastic potential / gravitational potential / nuclear)** store.

8 What is the unit of energy? Tick **one** box. **[1 mark]**

- [x] joule
- [ ] newton
- [ ] watt
- [ ] kilogram

9 A child lands on a trampoline. Describe the energy transfer as the mat and springs stretch and the child slows down. **[2 marks]**

Energy is transferred mechanically from the kinetic store of the child (1) to the elastic potential store of the trampoline (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- Energy is measured in **joules (J)**. It is never made or destroyed.
- Main stores: kinetic, gravitational potential, elastic potential, thermal, chemical.
- Transfers: mechanically, electrically, by heating, by waves.
- In a closed system, the total energy stays the same.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 What is the unit of energy?

2 Name four energy stores.

3 Is light a store or a way of transferring energy?

4 What is a closed system?

I CAN…

- name the energy stores
- name the four ways energy is transferred
- explain what a system is
- describe energy transfers using “from … to …”

Lesson

02 THE KINETIC STORE

AQA Physics 4.1.1.2; Combined Science 6.1.1.2

BIG QUESTION **A car travels twice as fast. Does it have twice as much energy in its kinetic store, or more?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- say what the kinetic store depends on
- calculate kinetic energy with $E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
- convert grams to kilograms
- explain why doubling the speed gives four times the energy

kinetic store | mass (kg) | speed (m/s) | squared

YOU WILL NEED

Calculator. Practical: trolley, 1.00 m track, stopwatch, balance.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

Which store does a moving object have energy in?

The kinetic store.

2

A car brakes. Which store fills?

The thermal store (of the brakes and the surroundings).

3

Light is _____ (a store / a way energy is transferred).

a way energy is transferred

A way energy is transferred (by waves).

EXPLAIN

ENERGY IN A MOVING OBJECT

Anything that moves has energy in its **kinetic store**. The more **mass** it has, and the faster it moves, the more energy it has.

$$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$$

kinetic energy = 0.5 × mass × (speed)²

E_k in joules (J), m in kilograms (kg), v in metres per second (m/s)

Only the speed is squared. In this unit you use the equation to calculate the energy.

! **Square the speed first:** $v^2 = v \times v$. Then multiply by the mass and by 0.5.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 1200 kg car moves at 15 m/s. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store.

KNOW	m = 1200 kg, v = 15 m/s
EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 1200 \times 15^2$
ANSWER	$E_k = 135\,000$ J

YOUR TURN

A 60 kg runner moves at 5.0 m/s. Calculate the energy in their kinetic store.

KNOW	**m = 60 kg, v = 5.0 m/s**
EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 60 \times 5.0^2$
ANSWER	$E_k = 750$ J

MASS IN GRAMS? CONVERT FIRST

The mass must be in kilograms. Divide grams by 1000: $450\ \text{g} = 0.450\ \text{kg}$. A 450 g football kicked at 20 m/s has $E_k = 0.5 \times 0.450 \times 20^2 = 90$ J.

DOUBLE THE SPEED, FOUR TIMES THE ENERGY

SPEED OF A 1200 KG CAR	v^2	E_k
15 m/s	225	135 000 J
30 m/s (2 × faster)	900	540 000 J (4 × more)
45 m/s (3 × faster)	2025	1 215 000 J (9 × more)

Twice the speed gives $2^2 = 4$ times the energy. Three times the speed gives $3^2 = 9$ times. This is why a crash at high speed does so much more damage, and why the brakes must transfer so much more energy to stop the car. Doubling the **mass** only doubles the energy, because the mass is not squared.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

Doubling the mass makes the kinetic energy

stay the same	**2 times bigger**	4 times bigger

Doubling the speed makes the kinetic energy

stay the same	2 times bigger	**4 times bigger**

2 SUPPORTED A 2.0 kg ball rolls at 3.0 m/s. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store.

EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 2.0 \times 3.0^2$
ANSWER	**9.0 J** unit:

3 SUPPORTED A 450 g football is kicked at 20 m/s. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store. *Convert the mass first!*

CONVERT	**m = 450 ÷ 1000 = 0.450 kg**
EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 0.450 \times 20^2$
ANSWER	**90 J** unit:

4 Complete the table. Show your working underneath.

Object	Mass	Speed	E_k / J
Lorry	**30 000 kg**	**2.0 m/s**	**60 000**
Cyclist and bike	**80 kg**	**6.0 m/s**	**1440**
Tennis ball	**58 g**	**50 m/s**	**72.5**
Bullet	**10 g**	**400 m/s**	**800**

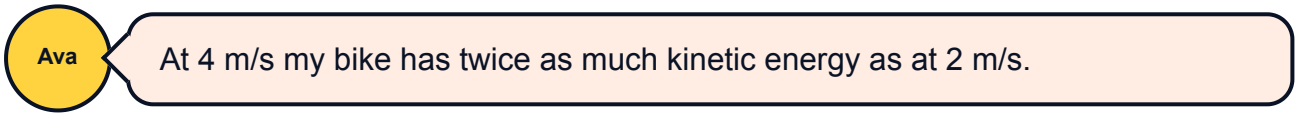
5 **ON YOUR OWN** A 0.16 kg cricket ball is bowled at 40 m/s. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store.

$E_k = 0.5 \times 0.16 \times 40^2 = 128$ J

6 **CHALLENGE** A car speeds up from 10 m/s to 30 m/s. How many times bigger is the energy in its kinetic store? Explain without calculating the energy.

9 times bigger. The speed is 3 times bigger, and the speed is squared: $3^2 = 9$.

7 Explain what is wrong with what Ava says.



The speed is squared, so doubling the speed gives $2^2 = 4$ times as much kinetic energy, not twice as much.

INVESTIGATE

MEASURE THE ENERGY OF A MOVING TROLLEY

Work in a group of three: one pushes, one times, one records.

1. Measure the trolley's mass on the balance in grams. Convert it to kilograms.
2. Mark a 1.00 m section of the track with tape.
3. Give the trolley a gentle push so it rolls through the section. Time how long it takes to cross the 1.00 m.
4. Repeat twice more with the same push, and find the mean time.
5. Calculate the speed, then the kinetic energy.

8. Record your results.

Mass / g	Mass / kg	Time 1 / s	Time 2 / s	Time 3 / s	Mean time / s
500	0.500	1.62	1.55	1.59	1.59

9. Calculate the speed: $\text{speed} = \dfrac{\text{distance}}{\text{time}}$.

EQUATION	$v = \dfrac{s}{t}$
SUBSTITUTE	$v = \dfrac{1.00}{1.59}$
ANSWER	**0.63 m/s (sample)** unit:

10. Calculate the energy in the trolley's kinetic store.

EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2}\, m\, v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 0.500 \times 0.63^2$
ANSWER	**0.10 J (sample)** unit:

11. Which measurement has the biggest effect on your answer? **the mass** / **the time**

Explain why.

The time: the speed is worked out from it, and the speed is squared, so any error in the time is made bigger.

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

Get the marks: Write the equation, then substitute, then give the answer with its unit.

12 A cyclist and bike have a total mass of 70 kg and move at 8.0 m/s. Calculate the energy in their kinetic store. **[2 marks]**

EQUATION	$E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_k = 0.5 \times 70 \times 8.0^2$ (1)
ANSWER	**2240 J (1)** unit:

13 Car A and car B have the same mass. Car B moves twice as fast as car A. Complete the sentence. **[2 marks]**

Car B has ___4___ **(2 / 4 / 8)** times as much energy in its kinetic store as car A, because in the equation the speed is **halved** / **squared** / **doubled**.

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- $E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$: mass in kg, speed in m/s, energy in J.
- Convert grams to kilograms: divide by 1000.
- Only the speed is squared: 2 × the speed gives 4 × the energy.
- 2 × the mass gives 2 × the energy.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 What two things does the kinetic store depend on?

2 Write the equation for kinetic energy.

3 Convert 250 g to kilograms.

4 The speed triples. What happens to the kinetic energy?

I CAN...

- calculate kinetic energy with $E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$
- convert grams to kilograms
- explain why doubling the speed gives four times the energy

Lesson

03 THE GRAVITATIONAL POTENTIAL STORE

AQA Physics 4.1.1.2; Combined Science 6.1.1.2

BIG QUESTION **Carrying a bag up the stairs is hard work. Where does that energy go, and can you get it back?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- explain what $g = 9.8$ N/kg means
- calculate energy with $E_p = m\,g\,h$
- use the height gained
- rearrange to find a height or a mass

gravitational potential store

gravitational field strength **newton (N)**

height gained

ELECTRIC MOUNTAIN

At Dinorwig in Wales, water is pumped up into a lake high on a mountain. When the country suddenly needs electricity, the water rushes down through turbines. The energy waits in the water's gravitational potential store until it is needed.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

In $E_k = \frac{1}{2}\,m\,v^2$, what does v stand for? Give its unit.

Speed, in metres per second (m/s).

2

Convert 600 g to kilograms.

0.600 kg

3

A 2.0 kg ball moves at 4.0 m/s. Calculate its kinetic energy.

$E_k = 0.5 \times 2.0 \times 4.0^2$

$E_k = 16$ J

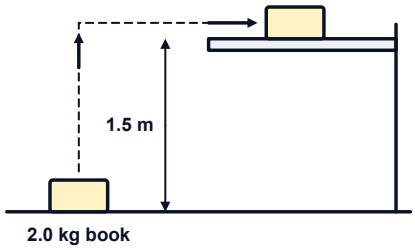
EXPLAIN

ENERGY FROM HEIGHT

Lift an object up and you transfer energy to its **gravitational potential store**. Let it fall and the energy is transferred to its kinetic store. The heavier the object and the higher you lift it, the more energy it stores.

WHAT g MEANS

! On Earth, gravity pulls every kilogram down with a force of **9.8 newtons**. We write this as $g = 9.8$ N/kg (newtons per kilogram). It is called the **gravitational field strength**. On the Moon, $g = 1.6$ N/kg, so the same lift stores less energy there.

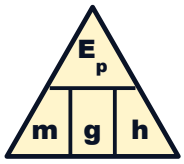


$$E_p = m\,g\,h$$

gravitational potential energy = mass × gravitational field strength × height

E_p in J, m in kg, g in N/kg, h in m

Rearranged: $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$ and $m = \dfrac{E_p}{g\,h}$



WORKED EXAMPLE

A 2.0 kg book is lifted onto a shelf 1.5 m high. Calculate the energy transferred to its gravitational potential store.

KNOW	m = 2.0 kg, g = 9.8 N/kg, h = 1.5 m
EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 2.0 \times 9.8 \times 1.5$
ANSWER	$E_p = 29.4$ J

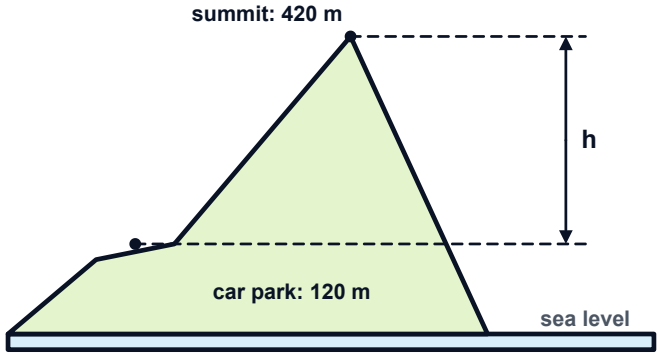
YOUR TURN

A 5.0 kg bag is lifted 2.0 m. Calculate the energy transferred to its gravitational potential store.

KNOW	**m = 5.0 kg, g = 9.8 N/kg, h = 2.0 m**
EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 5.0 \times 9.8 \times 2.0$
ANSWER	$E_p = 98$ J

USE THE HEIGHT GAINED

Only the **change** in height matters. A hiker climbs from a car park 120 m above sea level to a summit 420 m above sea level. The height gained is $h = 420 - 120 = 300$ m. A 55 kg hiker gains $E_p = 55 \times 9.8 \times 300 = 161\,700$ J.



FINDING THE HEIGHT OR THE MASS

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 60 kg climber gains 17 640 J in their gravitational potential store. How high did they climb?

KNOW	$E_p = 17\,640$ J, m = 60 kg, g = 9.8 N/kg
REARRANGE	$h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$
SUBSTITUTE	$h = \dfrac{17\,640}{60 \times 9.8}$
ANSWER	**h = 30 m**

YOUR TURN

A crate is lifted 2.0 m and gains 392 J. Calculate its mass.

KNOW	$E_p = 392$ J, g = 9.8 N/kg, h = 2.0 m
REARRANGE	$m = \dfrac{E_p}{g\,h}$
SUBSTITUTE	$m = \dfrac{392}{9.8 \times 2.0}$
ANSWER	**m = 20 kg**

Get the marks: Work out the bottom of the fraction first ($60 \times 9.8 = 588$), then divide. Or put brackets round it on your calculator.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

On the Moon, lifting a box 1 m stores

more energy than on Earth	less energy than on Earth	
the same energy as on Earth		

Lifting a box twice as high makes the energy stored

half as big	twice as big	four times as big

2 SUPPORTED A 0.50 kg ball is lifted 3.0 m. Calculate the energy transferred to its gravitational potential store.

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 0.50 \times 9.8 \times 3.0$
ANSWER	**14.7 J** unit:

3 **SUPPORTED** A 600 g book is lifted 1.2 m onto a shelf. Calculate the energy transferred. *Convert the mass first!*

CONVERT	**m = 600 ÷ 1000 = 0.600 kg**
EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 0.600 \times 9.8 \times 1.2$
ANSWER	**7.1 J** unit:

4 Complete the table. Use $g = 9.8$ N/kg. Show your working underneath.

Object	Mass / kg	Height gained / m	E_p / J
Child at the top of a slide	**30**	**2.5**	**735**
Rock on a cliff	**4.0**	**5.0**	**196**
Crate on a lorry	**30**	**3.0**	**882**
Lift with passengers	**800**	**12**	**94 080**

5 **CHALLENGE** A 50 kg student gains 4.9 kJ in their gravitational potential store climbing stairs. How high did they climb? *Convert kJ to J first.*

$E_p = 4900$ J; $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g} = \dfrac{4900}{50 \times 9.8} = 10$ m

INVESTIGATE

ACTIVITY: LIFT IT

Work in pairs. Lift gently and keep the floor clear.

Choose three objects. Measure the mass of each and the height of the shelf or bench you lift it onto. Calculate the energy transferred to each gravitational potential store.

6 Record and calculate.

Object	Mass / kg	Height / m	E_p / J
textbook	1.2	0.90	10.6
water bottle	0.50	0.90	4.4
school bag	4.0	0.90	35.3

7 How high would you need to lift your lightest object so that it stores the same energy as your heaviest object?

Sample: $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g} = \dfrac{35.3}{0.50 \times 9.8} = 7.2\ \text{m}$

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

> **Get the marks:** g is always given in the question. AQA uses 9.8 N/kg.

8 A crane lifts a 250 kg load through a height of 12 m. Calculate the energy transferred to the load's gravitational potential store. Gravitational field strength = 9.8 N/kg **[2 marks]**

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 250 \times 9.8 \times 12$ (1)
ANSWER	**29 400 J (1)** unit:

9 A 0.40 kg ball gains 7.84 J in its gravitational potential store when it is thrown upwards. Calculate how high it rises. Gravitational field strength = 9.8 N/kg **[3 marks]**

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
REARRANGE	$h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$ (1)
SUBSTITUTE	$h = \dfrac{7.84}{0.40 \times 9.8}$ (1)
ANSWER	**2.0 m (1)** unit:

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- $g = 9.8$ N/kg: gravity pulls each kilogram down with 9.8 N.
- $E_p = m\,g\,h$, with the height gained in metres.
- Rearranged: $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$ and $m = \dfrac{E_p}{g\,h}$.
- Twice the height or twice the mass gives twice the energy.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 What does $g = 9.8$ N/kg mean?

2 Write the equation for gravitational potential energy.

3 A 5.0 kg bag is lifted 2.0 m. How much energy does it gain?

4 Rearrange $E_p = m\,g\,h$ to find h.

I CAN...

- explain what $g = 9.8$ N/kg means
- calculate $E_p = m\,g\,h$ using the height gained
- rearrange $E_p = m\,g\,h$ to find a height or a mass

Lesson

04 STRETCHING SPRINGS

AQA Physics 4.5.3; Combined Science 6.5.3

BIG QUESTION **A trampoline spring stretches a lot when you land on it. A car's suspension spring hardly moves when you sit in the car. What makes one spring stiffer than another?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- explain why two forces are needed to stretch a spring
- tell elastic and inelastic deformation apart
- use $F = k\,e$ to find a force, a spring constant or an extension
- plot two graphs of the same results and find the spring constant

extension **spring constant (N/m)** **elastic deformation** **inelastic deformation** **limit of proportionality**

YOU WILL NEED

Clamp stand, spring, mass hanger, 100 g masses, metre rule, pointer, safety goggles.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

In $E_p = m\,g\,h$, what does g stand for? Give its value on Earth.

Gravitational field strength: 9.8 N/kg.

2

A 2.0 kg box is lifted 3.0 m. Calculate the energy transferred to its gravitational potential store.

$E_p = 2.0 \times 9.8 \times 3.0$

$E_p = 58.8$ J

3

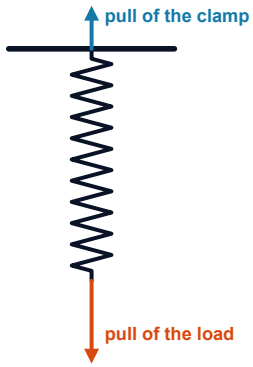
Convert 12 cm to metres.

0.12 m

EXPLAIN

STRETCH, SQUASH, BEND

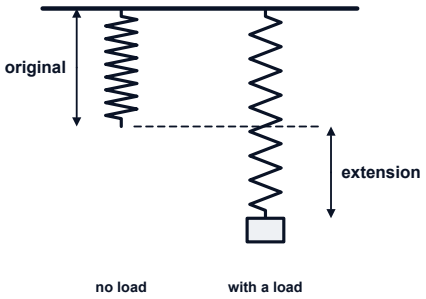
To stretch a spring and keep it still, you need **two forces**, one pulling each end. Here the clamp pulls the top up, and the load pulls the bottom down. With only one force, the spring would just move.



Elastic deformation: the spring goes back to its original length when the force is removed.
Inelastic deformation: the spring stays stretched.

EXTENSION

> ! **extension = stretched length − original length**
> Always record the **extension**, not the length.



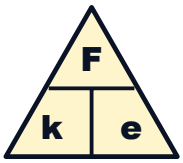
If a spring is 5.0 cm long with no load and 9.0 cm long with a load, its extension is 9.0 − 5.0 = 4.0 cm.

$$F = k\,e$$

force = spring constant × extension

F in newtons (N), k in newtons per metre (N/m), e in metres (m)

Rearranged: $k = \frac{F}{e}$ and $e = \frac{F}{k}$



The **spring constant** k tells you how stiff a spring is: the force needed for each metre of extension. A stiffer spring has a bigger k. In Lesson 5 you will use k to work out how much energy a stretched spring stores.

> ! **Hooke's law:** the extension of a spring is directly proportional to the force on it, as long as the **limit of proportionality** is not passed. Double the force, double the extension.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A spring stretches by 4.0 cm when a force of 2.0 N acts on it. Calculate its spring constant.

KNOW	F = 2.0 N, e = 4.0 cm = 0.040 m
REARRANGE	$k = \frac{F}{e}$
SUBSTITUTE	$k = \frac{2.0}{0.040}$
ANSWER	**k = 50 N/m**

YOUR TURN

A spring with k = 40 N/m is stretched by 0.15 m. Calculate the force.

KNOW	**k = 40 N/m, e = 0.15 m**
EQUATION	$F = ke$
SUBSTITUTE	$F = 40 \times 0.15$
ANSWER	**F = 6.0 N**

MASSES INTO FORCES AT THE BENCH

! Gravity pulls each kilogram down with 9.8 N, so each 100 g pulls down with 0.98 N. At the bench we round this: **each 100 g pulls down with about 1 N**. A mass is not a force: always record the force in newtons.

INVESTIGATE

PRACTICAL: STRETCHING A SPRING

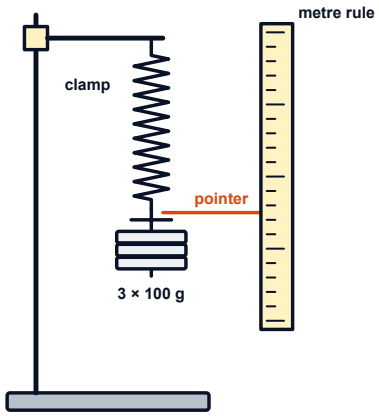
Work in pairs. Stand up while you work.

Before you start, write the question this practical answers and name its variables.

Question	**How does the extension of a spring depend on the force pulling it?**
Independent variable	**the force (the load we add)**
Dependent variable	**the extension**
Control variable	**the same spring for every reading**

STAY SAFE

- Wear safety goggles: a spring that slips off can whip.
- Keep your feet out from under the masses.
- Add masses gently. Do not let them drop.



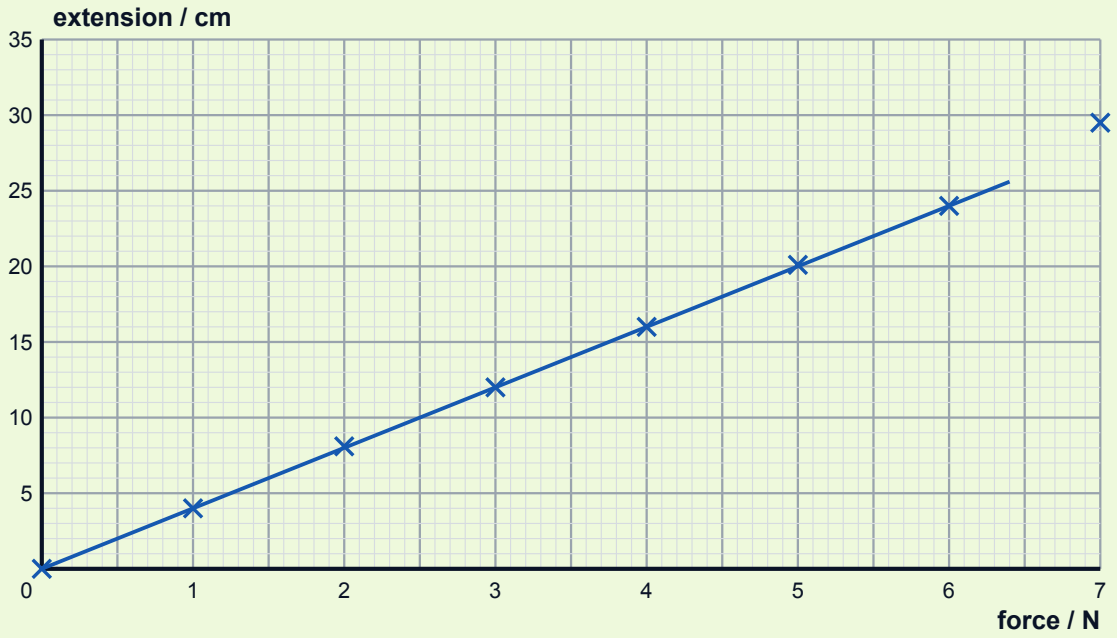
1. Line the pointer up with the metre rule. Record the original length.
2. Add a 100 g mass. Record the new length.
3. Repeat in 100 g steps up to 700 g.
4. Work out the force and the extension for each load.
5. Take the masses off one at a time. Does the spring go back to its original length?

6. Record your results. The force is about 1 N for each 100 g.

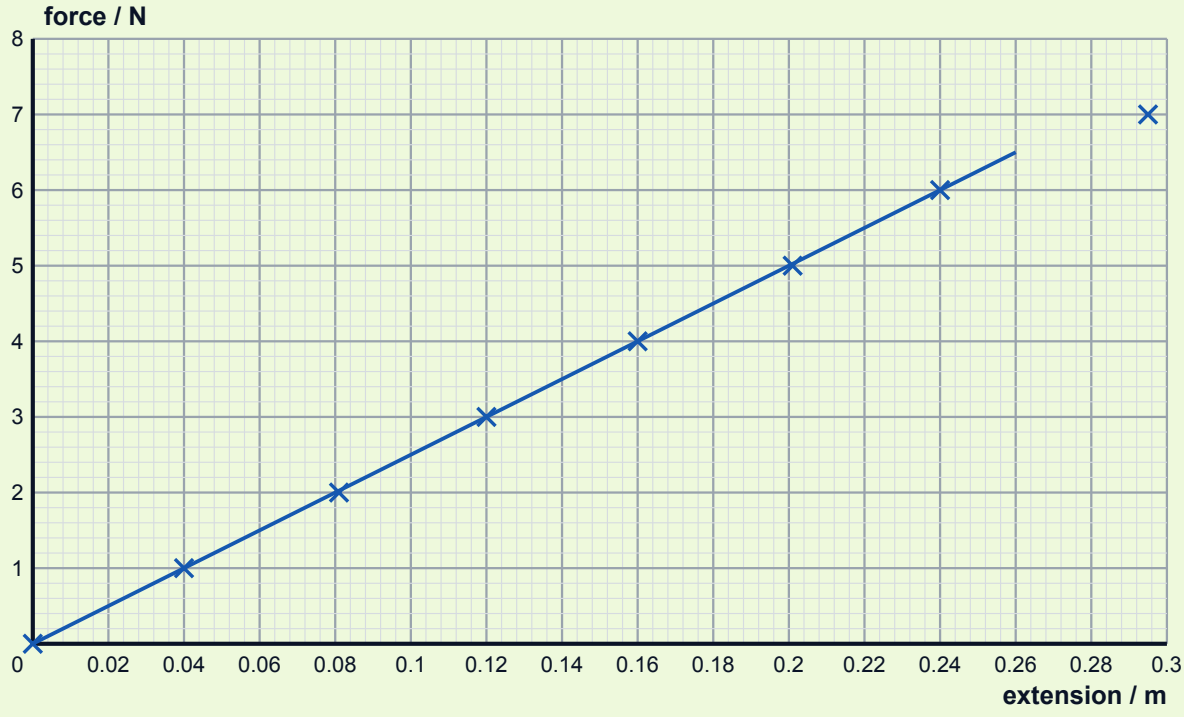
Mass added / g	Force / N	Length / cm	Extension / cm
0	0	5.0	0.0
100	1	9.0	4.0
200	2	13.1	8.1
300	3	17.0	12.0
400	4	21.0	16.0
500	5	25.1	20.1
600	6	29.0	24.0
700	7	34.5	29.5

TWO GRAPHS OF THE SAME RESULTS

7 **Graph 1: extension against force.** The independent variable goes on the x-axis, so the x-axis shows | force | extension | . Plot the points and draw a best-fit line. This graph answers our question: how does the extension change as the force increases?



8 **Graph 2: force against extension.** Swap the axes, so the dependent variable is now on the x-axis. We draw it this way because its gradient is the spring constant. Convert the extensions to metres first. Plot the points and draw a best-fit line.



9 Use graph 2 to find the spring constant. On graph 2, k is the gradient:

$$k = \frac{\text{change in force}}{\text{change in extension}}.$$

EQUATION	$k = \frac{\Delta F}{\Delta e}$
SUBSTITUTE	$k = \frac{6.0}{0.240}$
ANSWER	**25 N/m (sample)** unit:

10 Both graphs show the same results. Complete the table to explain the difference.

	Y-AXIS	X-AXIS	THE GRADIENT TELLS YOU
Graph 1	extension	force	how stretchy the spring is / how stiff the spring is **how stretchy the spring is (extension per newton)**
Graph 2	force	extension	how stretchy the spring is / how stiff the spring is **how stiff the spring is: its spring constant k**

11 A stiffer spring is tested. Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

On graph 1, its line would be **steeper** / **less steep**

On graph 2, its line would be **steeper** / **less steep**

12 Which reading is beyond the limit of proportionality? How can you tell from the graphs?

The 700 g (7 N) reading: its point is off the straight line on both graphs.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

Elastic deformation means the object **goes back to its original shape** / **stays stretched**

A spring with a bigger spring constant is **stiffer** / **easier to stretch**

2 **SUPPORTED** A spring is 6.0 cm long. With a load on it, it is 9.5 cm long. Calculate the extension.

EQUATION	**extension = stretched length − original length**
SUBSTITUTE	**extension = 9.5 − 6.0**
ANSWER	**3.5 cm** unit:

3 **SUPPORTED** Calculate the force needed to stretch a spring with k = 200 N/m by 0.050 m.

EQUATION	$F = k\,e$
SUBSTITUTE	$F = 200 \times 0.050$
ANSWER	**10 N** unit:

4 **ON YOUR OWN** A force of 3.0 N stretches a spring by 10 cm. Calculate its spring constant.

$e = 0.10$ m; $k = \frac{F}{e} = \frac{3.0}{0.10} = 30$ N/m

5 **ON YOUR OWN** A spring with k = 40 N/m has a force of 2.0 N on it. Calculate the extension. Give your answer in cm.

$e = \frac{F}{k} = \frac{2.0}{40} = 0.050$ m = 5.0 cm

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

> **Get the marks:** Convert the extension to metres before you divide.

13 A force of 5.0 N stretches a spring by 25 cm. Calculate the spring constant of the spring. **[3 marks]**

CONVERT	e = 25 cm = 0.25 m (1)
EQUATION	$k = \frac{F}{e}$
SUBSTITUTE	$k = \frac{5.0}{0.25}$ (1)
ANSWER	20 N/m (1) unit:

14 Describe what happens to the extension of a spring when the force on it is doubled. Assume the limit of proportionality is not passed. **[2 marks]**

The extension doubles (1), because extension is directly proportional to force (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- Two forces are needed to stretch, squash or bend an object.
- Extension = stretched length − original length.
- $F = ke$: k in N/m, e in metres.
- On a force–extension graph (force on the y-axis), the gradient is k.
- Hooke's law holds up to the limit of proportionality.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 What is the extension of a spring?

2 Write the equation linking force, spring constant and extension.

3 What is the unit of spring constant?

4 What does inelastic deformation mean?

I CAN...

- explain why two forces are needed to stretch a spring
- calculate an extension from two lengths
- use $F = ke$ and its rearrangements
- plot both graphs and find k from the gradient

Lesson

05 THE ELASTIC POTENTIAL STORE

AQA Physics 4.1.1.2, 4.5.3; Combined Science 6.1.1.2, 6.5.3

BIG QUESTION **An archer pulls a bowstring back twice as far. Does the arrow get twice as much energy, or more?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- calculate elastic potential energy with $E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$
- find k first when you are given a force
- explain why doubling the extension gives four times the energy
- say when the equation can be used

elastic potential store | work done | compression

BUNGEE

A bungee cord is a giant elastic band. As the jumper falls, the cord stretches and fills its elastic potential store. That slows the jumper down safely, then springs them back up.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

A spring has k = 50 N/m. Calculate the force that stretches it by 0.10 m.

$F = k\,e = 50 \times 0.10 = 5.0$

N

2

What is the unit of spring constant?

N/m

3

Doubling the speed makes the kinetic energy

4 (2 / 4 / 8)

times bigger.

4

EXPLAIN

ENERGY IN A STRETCHED SPRING

When you stretch or squash a spring, you **do work** on it: your force transfers energy to it. The energy is stored in the spring's **elastic potential store**. Let go, and the spring gives the energy back.

$$E_e = \tfrac{1}{2}\, k\, e^2$$

elastic potential energy = 0.5 × spring constant × (extension)²

E_e in J, k in N/m, e in metres (m)

Only the extension is squared. For a squashed spring, e is how much shorter it is. In this unit you use the equation to calculate the energy.

! The equation works only up to the **limit of proportionality**. Beyond it, the spring may be permanently stretched and will not give all the energy back.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A spring with k = 50 N/m is stretched by 0.040 m. Calculate the energy in its elastic potential store.

KNOW	k = 50 N/m, e = 0.040 m
EQUATION	$E_e = \tfrac{1}{2}\, k\, e^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_e = 0.5 \times 50 \times 0.040^2$
ANSWER	$E_e = 0.04$ J

YOUR TURN

A spring with k = 200 N/m is squashed by 0.050 m. Calculate the energy stored.

KNOW	**k = 200 N/m, e = 0.050 m**
EQUATION	$E_e = \tfrac{1}{2}\, k\, e^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_e = 0.5 \times 200 \times 0.050^2$
ANSWER	$E_e = 0.25$ J

GIVEN A FORCE? FIND k FIRST

WORKED EXAMPLE

A force of 3.0 N stretches a spring by 10 cm. Calculate the energy stored.

KNOW	F = 3.0 N, e = 10 cm = 0.10 m
STEP 1	$k = \dfrac{F}{e} = \dfrac{3.0}{0.10} = 30$ N/m
STEP 2	$E_e = \tfrac{1}{2}\, k\, e^2 = 0.5 \times 30 \times 0.10^2$
ANSWER	$E_e = 0.15$ J

YOUR TURN

A force of 4.0 N stretches a spring by 0.20 m. Calculate the energy stored.

KNOW	**F = 4.0 N, e = 0.20 m**
STEP 1	$k = \dfrac{4.0}{0.20} = 20$ N/m
STEP 2	$E_e = 0.5 \times 20 \times 0.20^2$
ANSWER	$E_e = 0.40$ J

DOUBLE THE STRETCH, FOUR TIMES THE ENERGY

EXTENSION OF A 50 N/M SPRING	e^2	E_e
0.040 m	0.0016	0.04 J
0.080 m (2 × further)	0.0064	0.16 J (4 × more)
0.120 m (3 × further)	0.0144	0.36 J (9 × more)

This is the same pattern as kinetic energy, because the extension is squared. **Why?** The further you stretch a spring, the harder you have to pull. So each extra centimetre takes more work than the one before.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

$E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$ can only be used up to the

limit of proportionality	**top of the ruler**	**point where the spring snaps**

Tripling the extension makes the energy stored

3 times bigger	**6 times bigger**	**9 times bigger**

2 SUPPORTED A spring with k = 80 N/m is stretched by 0.10 m. Calculate the energy stored.

EQUATION	$E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_e = 0.5 \times 80 \times 0.10^2$
ANSWER	**0.40 J** unit:

3 **SUPPORTED** A spring in a toy car has k = 400 N/m and is squashed by 20 mm. Calculate the energy stored. *Convert mm to m: divide by 1000.*

CONVERT	**e = 20 ÷ 1000 = 0.020 m**
EQUATION	$E_e = \frac{1}{2} k e^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_e = 0.5 \times 400 \times 0.020^2$
ANSWER	**0.08 J** unit:

4 **ON YOUR OWN** A force of 6.0 N stretches a spring by 0.15 m. Calculate the energy stored.

$k = \frac{6.0}{0.15} = 40$ N/m; $E_e = 0.5 \times 40 \times 0.15^2 = 0.45$ J

5 Raj's spring has k = 30 N/m. What did he do wrong? Calculate the correct answer.

> **Raj:** e = 10 cm, so the energy stored is 0.5 × 30 × 10² = 1500 J.

He used the extension in cm, not m. e = 0.10 m, so the energy is 0.5 × 30 × 0.10² = 0.15 J.

6 **CHALLENGE** Spring A has k = 100 N/m and is stretched by 0.10 m. Spring B has k = 50 N/m and is stretched by 0.20 m. Which spring stores more energy? Show your working.

A: 0.5 × 100 × 0.10² = 0.50 J. B: 0.5 × 50 × 0.20² = 1.0 J. Spring B stores more.

INVESTIGATE

YOUR OWN SPRING

Use the spring constant you found in Lesson 4.

7 My spring constant from Lesson 4: k = 25 N/m. Calculate the energy stored at each extension.

Extension / m	e^2 / m²	E_e / J
0.05	0.0025	0.031
0.10	0.010	0.125
0.20	0.040	0.50

8 Check: did doubling the extension from 0.10 m to 0.20 m give four times the energy?

yes / no Show how you know.

0.50 ÷ 0.125 = 4 (sample).

9 Could you use $E_e = \frac{1}{2} k e^2$ for the 700 g reading in Lesson 4? yes / no

Explain.

No: that reading was beyond the limit of proportionality, so k was not constant.

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

Get the marks: Square only the extension. Give the unit.

10 A catapult has a spring constant of 500 N/m. It is stretched by 0.12 m. Calculate the energy in its elastic potential store. **[2 marks]**

EQUATION	$E_e = \frac{1}{2} k e^2$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_e = 0.5 \times 500 \times 0.12^2$ (1)
ANSWER	3.6 J (1) unit:

11 Explain why $E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$ cannot be used once the spring has passed its limit of proportionality. **[2 marks]**

Beyond the limit of proportionality the extension is no longer proportional to the force, so k is not constant (1). The spring may be inelastically deformed and not return all the energy (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- $E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$: k in N/m, e in metres, E_e in J.
- The work done stretching a spring is stored in its elastic potential store.
- Given a force and an extension? Find $k = \dfrac{F}{e}$ first.
- 2 × the extension gives 4 × the energy.
- Only up to the limit of proportionality.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 Write the equation for elastic potential energy.

2 What unit must the extension be in?

3 The extension doubles. What happens to the energy stored?

4 When can the equation not be used?

I CAN...

- calculate $E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$ with the extension in metres
- find k from a force first, then calculate E_e
- explain why doubling the extension gives four times the energy

Lesson

06 CONSERVATION OF ENERGY

AQA Physics 4.1.2.1, 4.1.1.1; Combined Science 6.1.2.1, 6.1.1.1

BIG QUESTION **A heavy pendulum is pulled back to touch your nose and let go. When it swings back, will it hit you?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- state the principle of conservation of energy
- follow energy from one store to another in a closed system
- use conservation of energy in calculations
- draw energy bar charts
- explain why real systems lose some useful energy

conservation of energy **closed system** **dissipated** **energy bar chart**

YOU WILL NEED

Practical: clamp stand, string, pendulum bob, metre rule, a phone to film the swing.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

A 1.0 kg ball is lifted 2.0 m. Calculate the energy transferred to its gravitational potential store.

$E_p = 1.0 \times 9.8 \times 2.0$

$E_p = 19.6$ J

2

A 2.0 kg ball moves at 3.0 m/s. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store.

$E_k = 0.5 \times 2.0 \times 3.0^2$

$E_k = 9.0$ J

3

A stretched spring stores energy in its **elastic potential** (kinetic / elastic potential) store.

elastic potential

EXPLAIN

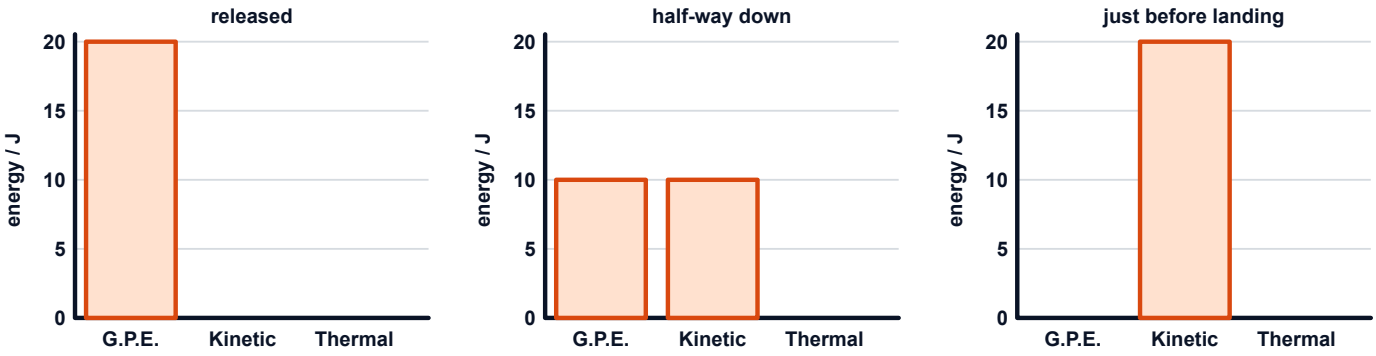
ENERGY IS NEVER LOST

! **Conservation of energy:** energy can be transferred usefully, stored or dissipated, but it cannot be created or destroyed.

In a **closed system**, the total energy never changes. Energy only moves from one store to another.

A FALLING BALL

As a ball falls, energy is transferred from its gravitational potential (G.P.E.) store to its kinetic store. If we ignore air resistance, all the energy that leaves the G.P.E. store arrives in the kinetic store. An **energy bar chart** shows this: the bars change, but the total stays the same.



WORKED EXAMPLE

A 0.50 kg ball is dropped from 3.0 m. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store just before it lands. Ignore air resistance.

IDEA	energy gained by the kinetic store = energy lost from the G.P.E. store
EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 0.50 \times 9.8 \times 3.0 = 14.7$ J
ANSWER	$E_k = 14.7$ J

YOUR TURN

A 2.0 kg rock falls 5.0 m. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store just before it lands. Ignore air resistance.

IDEA	**energy gained by the kinetic store = energy lost from the G.P.E. store**
EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 2.0 \times 9.8 \times 5.0 = 98$ J
ANSWER	$E_k = 98$ J

FINDING A HEIGHT

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 0.25 kg ball is thrown straight up with 20 J in its kinetic store. Calculate the greatest height it reaches. Ignore air resistance.

IDEA	at the top, all 20 J is in the G.P.E. store
REARRANGE	$h = \frac{E_p}{m\,g}$
SUBSTITUTE	$h = \frac{20}{0.25 \times 9.8}$
ANSWER	**h = 8.2 m**

YOUR TURN

A 0.10 kg ball is thrown straight up with 4.9 J in its kinetic store. How high does it go? Ignore air resistance.

IDEA	**at the top, all 4.9 J is in the G.P.E. store**
REARRANGE	$h = \frac{E_p}{m\,g}$
SUBSTITUTE	$h = \frac{4.9}{0.10 \times 9.8}$
ANSWER	**h = 5.0 m**

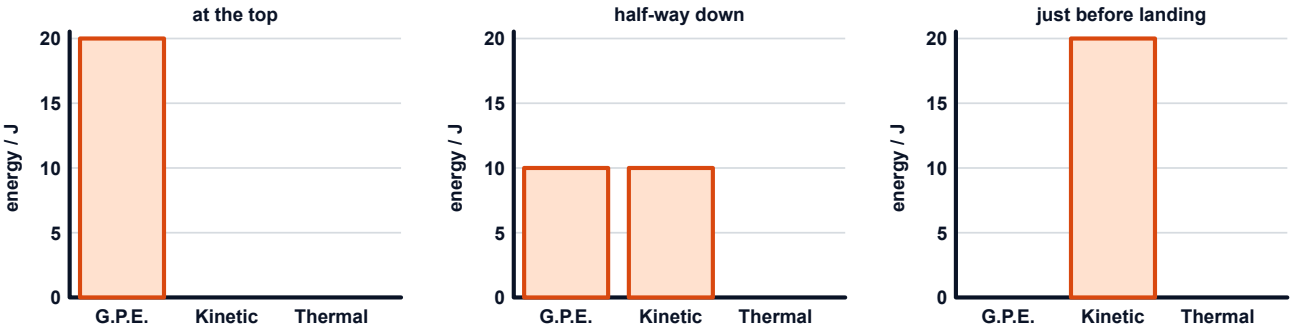
REAL SYSTEMS: SOME ENERGY IS DISSIPATED

In real life, air resistance and friction transfer some energy to the **thermal store** of the surroundings. This energy is not destroyed, but it is spread out and we cannot use it again. We say it is **dissipated**. That is why a pendulum swings a little lower each time, and why it will not hit your nose.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1. A ball has 20 J in its G.P.E. store at the top. Ignore air resistance. Draw the bars at each moment.



2 Complete the sentences. The choices are after each gap.

At the top of its swing, a pendulum has most energy in its **gravitational potential** **(kinetic / gravitational potential)** store.

At the bottom of its swing, it has most energy in its **kinetic** **(kinetic / gravitational potential)** store.

The total energy **stays the same** **(goes up / goes down / stays the same)** if we ignore air resistance.

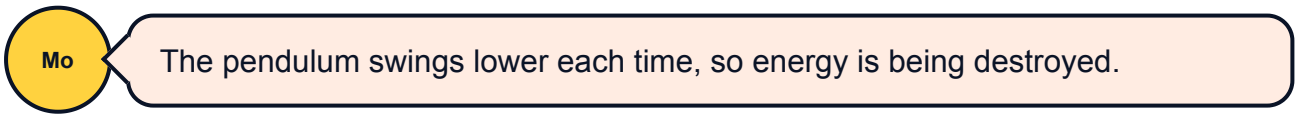
3 **ON YOUR OWN** A 0.20 kg apple falls 2.5 m from a tree. Calculate the energy in its kinetic store just before it lands. Ignore air resistance.

$E_k = E_p = 0.20 \times 9.8 \times 2.5 = 4.9$ J

4 **CHALLENGE** A toy launcher has a spring with k = 200 N/m, squashed by 0.050 m. It fires a 10 g ball straight up. Calculate the greatest height the ball could reach.

$E_e = 0.5 \times 200 \times 0.050^2 = 0.25$ J. At the top, $E_p = 0.25$ J. $h = \dfrac{0.25}{0.010 \times 9.8} = 2.6$ m

5 Explain why Mo is wrong.



Energy cannot be destroyed. It is dissipated: transferred to the thermal store of the surroundings by air resistance and friction.

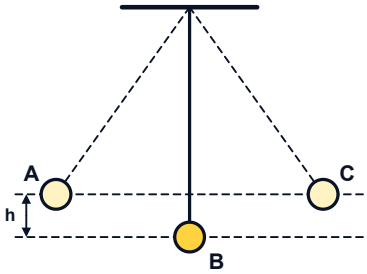
INVESTIGATE

PRACTICAL: DOES THE PENDULUM KEEP ITS ENERGY?

Every reading is a height, so you do not need fast timing.

STAY SAFE

- Clamp the stand firmly so it cannot tip.
- Let the bob go from rest; never push it.
- Keep clear of the swing.



1. Hang the bob. Note the height of its lowest point on the metre rule.
2. Pull the bob to the side until it is 0.20 m higher than its lowest point (A). Let go.
3. Read the height it reaches on the other side (C). Filming helps.
4. Let it keep swinging. Read the height it reaches after 10 swings.

6. Mass of the bob = **0.20** kg. Record the heights and calculate the energy in the G.P.E. store each time.

Moment	Height above lowest point / m	E_p / J
Released	**0.20**	**0.39**
After 1 swing	**0.19**	**0.37**
After 10 swings	**0.12**	**0.24**

7. On the first swing, how much energy is in the bob's kinetic store at the lowest point B? Explain.

About 0.39 J (sample): all the energy lost from the G.P.E. store goes to the kinetic store (a little less in real life).

8 After 10 swings, the energy has been **created** | **destroyed** | **dissipated**. Where has it gone?

To the thermal store of the air and the surroundings, through air resistance and friction at the support.

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

> **Get the marks:** In part (b), say why the two energies are equal.

9 A diver of mass 60 kg stands on a board 10 m above the water. Gravitational field strength = 9.8 N/kg. **[2 marks]**

(a) Calculate the energy in the diver's gravitational potential store.

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 60 \times 9.8 \times 10$ **(1)**
ANSWER	**5880 J (1)** unit:

10 (b) The diver falls into the water. Ignoring air resistance, how much energy is in the diver's kinetic store just before they reach the water? Give a reason. **[2 marks]**

5880 J (1). All the energy lost from the gravitational potential store is transferred to the kinetic store (1).

11 (c) In real life, the energy in the kinetic store is a little less. Explain why. **[2 marks]**

Air resistance acts on the diver (1), so some energy is transferred to the thermal store of the air / surroundings (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- Energy cannot be created or destroyed, only transferred, stored or dissipated.
- In a closed system the total energy stays the same.
- Falling: G.P.E. store → kinetic store. Rising: kinetic store → G.P.E. store.
- Energy bar charts: the bars change, the total stays the same.
- Real systems dissipate some energy to the thermal store of the surroundings.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 State the principle of conservation of energy.

2 A ball falls and loses 12 J of G.P.E. Ignoring air resistance, how much does its kinetic store gain?

3 Why does a pendulum swing lower each time?

4 What does an energy bar chart show?

I CAN…

- state the principle of conservation of energy
- use energy lost = energy gained in calculations
- draw energy bar charts
- explain why real systems dissipate energy

Lesson

07 POWER

AQA Physics 4.1.1.4; Combined Science 6.1.1.4

BIG QUESTION **Two students carry the same bag up the same stairs. One runs and one walks. Who transferred more energy? Who was more powerful?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- say what power means
- state that 1 watt is 1 joule per second
- calculate power with $P = \frac{E}{t}$, and find E or t
- convert kW to W, kJ to J and minutes to seconds

power | watt (W) | kilowatt (kW) | rate

YOU WILL NEED

Practical: stopwatch, tape measure or metre rule, a flight of stairs.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

A 50 kg student climbs 3.0 m of stairs. Calculate the energy transferred to their G.P.E. store.

$E_p = 50 \times 9.8 \times 3.0$

$E_p = 1470$ J

2

Convert 2.0 minutes to seconds.

120 s

3

State the principle of conservation of energy.

Energy can be transferred usefully, stored or dissipated, but cannot be created or destroyed.

EXPLAIN

HOW FAST IS ENERGY TRANSFERRED?

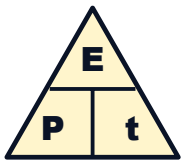
Power is how fast energy is transferred: the energy transferred **each second**. Two motors can lift the same load through the same height, so they transfer the same energy. The motor that does it faster is more powerful.

$$P = \frac{E}{t}$$

power = energy transferred ÷ time

P in watts (W), E in joules (J), t in seconds (s)

Rearranged: $E = Pt$ and $t = \frac{E}{P}$



! **1 watt (W) = 1 joule per second.** 1 kilowatt (kW) = 1000 W. A 60 W lamp transfers 60 J every second.

	ENERGY TRANSFERRED	TIME	POWER
Motor A	29.4 J	2.0 s	29.4 ÷ 2.0 = 14.7 W
Motor B	29.4 J	6.0 s	29.4 ÷ 6.0 = 4.9 W

WORKED EXAMPLE

A motor transfers 600 J in 4.0 s. Calculate its power.

KNOW E = 600 J, t = 4.0 s

EQUATION $P = \frac{E}{t}$

SUBSTITUTE $P = \frac{600}{4.0}$

ANSWER **P = 150 W**

YOUR TURN

A lamp transfers 900 J in 15 s. Calculate its power.

KNOW **E = 900 J, t = 15 s**

EQUATION $P = \frac{E}{t}$

SUBSTITUTE $P = \frac{900}{15}$

ANSWER **P = 60 W**

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 2.0 kW kettle is switched on for 2.0 minutes. Calculate the energy transferred.

CONVERT P = 2000 W, t = 120 s

REARRANGE $E = Pt$

SUBSTITUTE $E = 2000 \times 120$

ANSWER **E = 240 000 J**

YOUR TURN

A 1500 W motor must transfer 45 000 J. How long does it take?

KNOW **P = 1500 W, E = 45 000 J**

REARRANGE $t = \frac{E}{P}$

SUBSTITUTE $t = \frac{45\,000}{1500}$

ANSWER **t = 30 s**

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

Power is measured in | **joules** | **watts** | **newtons** |

A more powerful motor transfers energy | **faster** | **slower** |

1 W is the same as | **1 J per second** | **1 J per minute** | **1 N per metre** |

2 SUPPORTED A 40 W fan runs for 5.0 minutes. Calculate the energy transferred. *Convert the time first!*

CONVERT	**t = 5.0 × 60 = 300 s**
EQUATION	$E = Pt$
SUBSTITUTE	$E = 40 \times 300$
ANSWER	**12 000 J** unit:

3 Complete the table. Show your working underneath.

Appliance	Energy / J	Time / s	Power / W
Fan	**1200**	**30**	**40**
Kettle	**120 000**	**60**	**2000**
Lamp	**5000**	**50**	**100**

4 CHALLENGE A 3.0 kW heater transfers 540 kJ. How many minutes was it on for?

$t = \frac{E}{P} = \frac{540\,000}{3000} = 180$ **s = 3.0 minutes**

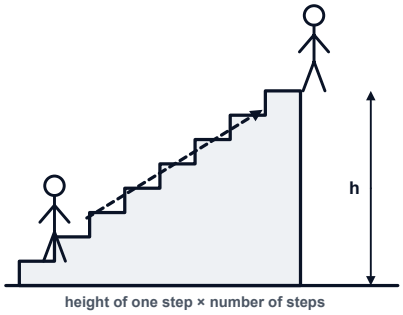
INVESTIGATE

PRACTICAL: HOW POWERFUL ARE YOU?

Everyone uses a mass of 50 kg, so nobody is weighed.

STAY SAFE

- Walk briskly. Do not run. Hold the handrail.
- One person on the stairs at a time.
- Use dry, clear stairs.



1. Measure the height of one step. Count the steps. Height h = step height × number of steps.
2. Your partner times you walking briskly up the stairs.
3. Calculate the energy transferred: $E = m\,g\,h$, with $m = 50$ kg.
4. Calculate your power: $P = \dfrac{E}{t}$.

Height of one step / m	**0.17**
Number of steps	**18**
Height h / m	**3.06**
Mass / kg	50
Time / s	**5.0**

5. Calculate the energy transferred to your G.P.E. store.

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 50 \times 9.8 \times 3.06$
ANSWER	**1500 J (sample)** unit:

6. Calculate your power.

EQUATION	$P = \dfrac{E}{t}$
SUBSTITUTE	$P = \dfrac{1500}{5.0}$
ANSWER	**300 W (sample)** unit:

7 Is your real power output ~~higher~~ **lower** than your answer? Explain.

Higher: you also transferred energy to your kinetic store and to the thermal store of your body and the air, not only to your G.P.E. store.

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

Get the marks: Two steps: find the energy first, then the power.

8 A lift motor raises a 600 kg lift through 15 m in 20 s. Gravitational field strength = 9.8 N/kg. **[2 marks]**

(a) Calculate the energy transferred to the lift's gravitational potential store.

EQUATION	$E_p = m\,g\,h$
SUBSTITUTE	$E_p = 600 \times 9.8 \times 15$ **(1)**
ANSWER	**88 200 J (1)** unit:

9 (b) Calculate the useful power output of the motor. **[2 marks]**

EQUATION	$P = \frac{E}{t}$
SUBSTITUTE	$P = \frac{88\,200}{20}$ **(1)**
ANSWER	**4410 W (1)** unit:

10 Motor A lifts a load in 5 s. Motor B lifts the same load through the same height in 10 s. Complete the sentence. **[2 marks]**

Motor A transfers **the same** **(more / less / the same)** energy as motor B, and has **a greater** **(a greater / a smaller / the same)** power.

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- Power is the rate of energy transfer: the energy transferred each second.
- $P = \frac{E}{t}$; $E = Pt$; $t = \frac{E}{P}$.
- 1 W = 1 J/s; 1 kW = 1000 W.
- Time in seconds: minutes × 60.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 What is power?

2 What is 1 watt?

3 A lamp transfers 600 J in 10 s. What is its power?

4 Write the equation to find energy from power and time.

I CAN…

- define power as the rate of energy transfer
- calculate $P = \frac{E}{t}$ and find E or t
- convert kW, kJ and minutes
- measure my own power

Lesson

08 WASTED ENERGY

AQA Physics 4.1.2.1; Combined Science 6.1.2.1

BIG QUESTION **A hot chocolate always goes cold. Where does the energy go, and how can you slow it down?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- explain what “dissipated” means and where the energy ends up
- explain how lubrication reduces unwanted energy transfers
- explain how thermal conductivity and wall thickness affect how fast a house cools
- suggest and explain ways to insulate a home

dissipated **friction** **lubrication** **conduction** **thermal conductivity** **thermal insulator**

SEEING HEAT

A thermal camera shows warm things as bright colours. Point one at a house in winter and the windows, the roof and the gaps round the door glow: that is where energy is escaping into the cold air outside.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

A fan transfers 600 J in 20 s. Calculate its power.

P = 600 ÷ 20 = 30 W

2

Dissipated energy usually ends up in the **thermal** **(thermal / chemical / nuclear)** store of the surroundings.

thermal

3

A pendulum swings lower each time. Why?

Some energy is dissipated by air resistance and friction.

EXPLAIN

REDUCING UNWANTED ENERGY TRANSFERS

In every real energy transfer, some energy goes to stores where it is not useful, usually the **thermal store of the surroundings**. This energy is **dissipated** (spread out). People often call it “wasted” energy. It is not destroyed, but we cannot use it again.

UNWANTED TRANSFER	HOW TO REDUCE IT	WHY IT WORKS
Friction between moving parts	Lubricate with oil or grease	The surfaces slide past each other more easily, so less energy goes to the thermal store
Air resistance on a vehicle	A streamlined shape	The air pushes back less, so less energy goes to the thermal store of the air
Conduction through walls and roofs	Thermal insulation	Materials with a low thermal conductivity slow the transfer

CONDUCTION AND THERMAL CONDUCTIVITY

Energy is transferred through a solid by **conduction**, from the hotter side to the colder side. A material with a **higher thermal conductivity** transfers energy **faster**. Metals have a high thermal conductivity. Air, wool and plastic foam have a low thermal conductivity, so they are good **thermal insulators**. Many insulators work because they trap air.

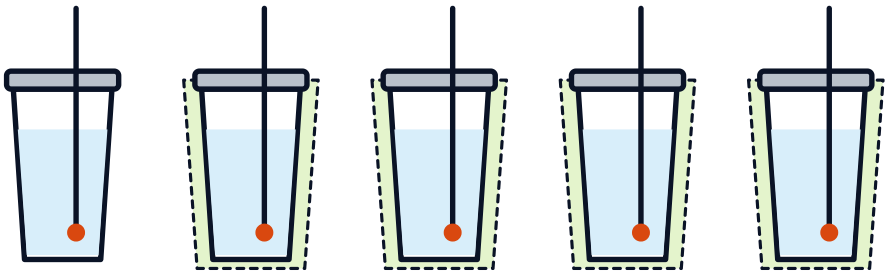
> ! A house cools **more slowly** if its walls are **thicker** and have a **lower thermal conductivity**.

INVESTIGATE

PRACTICAL: COOLING CUPS

TRIPLE ONLY

Your teacher pours the hot water.



Question: which material is the best thermal insulator?

Independent variable	**the insulating material**
Dependent variable	**the temperature drop in 10 minutes**
Control variables (two)	**volume of water, starting temperature, type of cup, thickness of wrapping, lid**

STAY SAFE

- The water is about 60 °C: hot enough to scald. Do not move the cups.
- Stand the cups in a tray. Report any spill straight away.

5 Record your results.

Material	Start / °C	After 10 min / °C	Drop / °C
none	**60**	**47**	**13**
newspaper	**60**	**52**	**8**
bubble wrap	**60**	**54**	**6**
cotton wool	**60**	**55**	**5**
felt	**60**	**53**	**7**

6 The material is a categoric variable, so draw a **line graph** / **bar chart** of the temperature drop. Draw it here.

Bar chart: one bar per material, temperature drop / °C on the y-axis.

7 Complete the conclusion.

The best insulator is the material whose cup had the **smallest** (biggest / smallest) temperature drop.

In my results, the best insulator was **cotton wool (sample)** (none / newspaper / bubble wrap / cotton wool / felt).

Good insulators trap air, which has a **low** (high / low) thermal conductivity.

PRACTISE

TRY IT

1 Draw a line from each unwanted energy transfer to the best way to reduce it.

Friction in a bike chain	a draught excluder
Air resistance on a lorry	oil on the chain
Conduction through a loft	a streamlined shape
Draughts under a door	thick loft insulation

2 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

Copper has a high thermal conductivity, so copper is a good

thermal insulator / **thermal conductor**

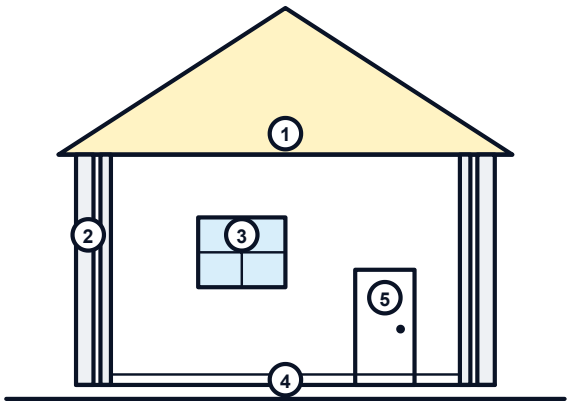
Making a wall twice as thick makes the house cool **faster** / **more slowly**

3 Explain what insulation really does.

Lily: Insulation keeps the cold out.

Insulation slows down the transfer of energy from the warm inside of the house to the colder outside.

4 DESIGN **Design an Eco House.** For each numbered place on the house, name a feature that reduces energy transfer out of the house, and explain why it works. Where they fit, use the words *thermal conductivity* or *thickness*. For gaps, explain how the feature stops warm air escaping.



PLACE	FEATURE	WHY IT WORKS
1 Roof	thick loft insulation	a thick layer of trapped air with a low thermal conductivity
2 Walls	cavity wall insulation	foam fills the gap; it has a low thermal conductivity
3 Window	double glazing	trapped air or gas between the panes has a low thermal conductivity
4 Floor	carpet or floor insulation	low thermal conductivity slows conduction into the ground
5 Door	draught excluder / insulated door	stops warm air escaping through gaps

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

Get the marks: Say what the lubricant does to friction, and then what that does to the energy.

8 Explain how oiling a bicycle chain reduces the energy wasted when you cycle. **[2 marks]**

Oil reduces friction between the moving parts (1), so less energy is transferred to the thermal store of the chain and surroundings (1).

9 Two houses have walls of the same thickness. The bricks of house A have a higher thermal conductivity than the bricks of house B. Which house cools faster? Explain. **[2 marks]**

House A (1): a higher thermal conductivity means energy is transferred through the walls by conduction faster (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- Dissipated ("wasted") energy usually goes to the thermal store of the surroundings.
- Lubrication reduces friction, so less energy is dissipated.
- Higher thermal conductivity = faster energy transfer by conduction.
- Thicker walls with lower thermal conductivity make a house cool more slowly.
- Many insulators trap air.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 Where does dissipated energy usually end up?

2 How does lubrication reduce wasted energy?

3 What does a high thermal conductivity mean?

4 Give two ways to make a house cool more slowly.

I CAN...

- explain what dissipated means
- explain how lubrication reduces wasted energy
- explain the effect of thermal conductivity and wall thickness
- design and justify ways to insulate a home

Lesson

09 EFFICIENCY

AQA Physics 4.1.2.2; Combined Science 6.1.2.2

BIG QUESTION **An old filament lamp and an LED give out the same light. Why does the LED cost much less to run?**

BY THE END YOU CAN

- calculate efficiency as a decimal and as a percentage
- explain why efficiency can never be more than 100%
- find the useful output or the total input from the efficiency
- draw and read Sankey diagrams
- describe ways to increase efficiency

efficiency | useful output | wasted output | total input | Sankey diagram

LAMPS

A filament lamp transfers only about 1 joule in every 10 by light. The rest heats the room. An LED transfers several times more of its energy by light, so it needs much less energy for the same brightness.

REMEMBER

DO NOW

From earlier lessons. No notes!

1

A 2000 W heater is on for 30 s. Calculate the energy transferred.

E = P t = 2000 × 30 = 60 000 J

2

Where does most wasted energy end up?

The thermal store of the surroundings.

3

Give one way to reduce friction in a machine.

Lubricate it with oil or grease.

EXPLAIN

HOW MUCH IS USEFUL?

Efficiency tells you what fraction of the energy put into a device is transferred usefully. The rest is wasted, usually dissipated to the thermal store of the surroundings.

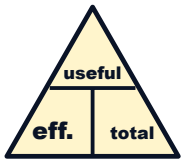
$$\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful output energy transfer}}{\text{total input energy transfer}}$$

Energy in joules (J). Efficiency has no unit.

Answer as a decimal (for example 0.80), or multiply by 100 for a percentage (80%).

Rearranged: useful output = efficiency × total input, and

$$\text{total input} = \frac{\text{useful output}}{\text{efficiency}}$$



$$\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful power output}}{\text{total power input}}$$

The same idea, using power in watts (W).

Use whichever pair the question gives you: energies or powers.

! Efficiency is **never more than 1** (100%). If your answer is bigger than 1, you have divided the wrong way round. To use a percentage in a calculation, change it to a decimal first: 25% = 0.25.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A motor is supplied with 500 J and transfers 400 J to the kinetic store of its load. Calculate its efficiency.

KNOW	useful = 400 J, total = 500 J
EQUATION	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful}}{\text{total}}$
SUBSTITUTE	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{400}{500}$
ANSWER	**0.80, or 80%**

YOUR TURN

A lamp is supplied with 60 J and transfers 12 J by light. Calculate its efficiency.

KNOW	**useful = 12 J, total = 60 J**
EQUATION	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful}}{\text{total}}$
SUBSTITUTE	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{12}{60}$
ANSWER	**0.20, or 20%**

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 60 W lamp has an efficiency of 25%. Calculate its useful power output.

CONVERT	efficiency = 25% = 0.25
REARRANGE	useful = efficiency × total
SUBSTITUTE	useful = 0.25 × 60
ANSWER	**15 W**

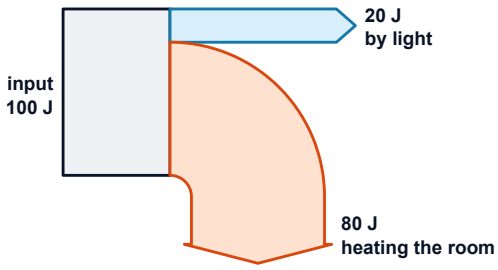
YOUR TURN

A motor is 0.80 efficient. It transfers 400 J usefully. Calculate the total energy supplied.

KNOW	**efficiency = 0.80, useful = 400 J**
REARRANGE	$\text{total} = \frac{\text{useful}}{\text{efficiency}}$
SUBSTITUTE	$\text{total} = \frac{400}{0.80}$
ANSWER	**500 J**

SANKEY DIAGRAMS

1. The **width** of each arrow shows the amount of energy.
2. Useful energy goes **straight on**. Wasted energy **bends away**, usually downwards.
3. Input = useful + wasted. Here: 100 J = 20 J + 80 J.
4. Efficiency = 20 ÷ 100 = 0.20 (20%).



A lamp: 100 J in, 20 J by light.

INCREASING EFFICIENCY

Reduce the wasted energy: **lubricate** moving parts (less friction), **streamline** vehicles (less air resistance), **insulate** hot things (less energy transferred by heating), and choose devices that waste less, such as LEDs instead of filament lamps.

PRACTISE

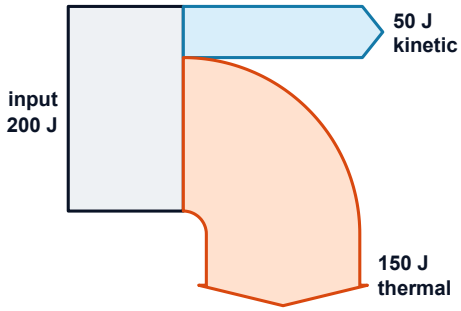
TRY IT

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

An efficiency of 1.4 is **possible** / **impossible**

Efficiency has the unit **joules** / **watts** / **no unit**

2 This is the Sankey diagram for an electric motor. Calculate its efficiency.



EQUATION	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful}}{\text{total}}$
SUBSTITUTE	$\text{efficiency} = \frac{50}{200}$
ANSWER	**0.25 (25%)** unit:

3 A kettle is supplied with 2000 J. It transfers 1800 J to the thermal store of the water, and 200 J heats the kettle and the room. Draw its Sankey diagram. Let 1 square = 100 J.

Input arrow 20 squares wide; useful arrow 18 squares wide straight on (water); wasted arrow 2 squares wide bending down (kettle and room).

4 Complete the table. Show your working underneath.

Device	Total input	Useful output	Efficiency
TV	200 J	60 J	0.30 (30%)
Electric motor	1000 J	750 J	0.75
Solar panel	200 W	30 W	0.15

5 Complete the sentences. The choices are after each gap.

Oiling the gears of a machine **increases** (increases / decreases) its efficiency, because less energy is transferred by **friction** (friction / light).

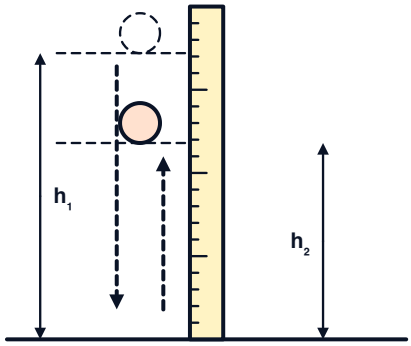
An LED is **more** (more / less) efficient than a filament lamp, because **less** (more / less) energy is wasted heating the room.

INVESTIGATE

PRACTICAL: HOW EFFICIENT IS A BOUNCE?

Filming the bounce against the ruler makes it much easier to read.

1. Measure the mass in kg. Drop the ball from 1.00 m.
2. Measure the height of the first bounce.
3. Repeat three times and find the mean bounce height.
4. Repeat with a different ball.



Measure both heights from the bottom of the ball. Use $E_p = m\,g\,h$ with $g = 9.8$ N/kg for each energy; then $\text{efficiency} = \dfrac{E_{p2}}{E_{p1}}$. Round only at the end.

6 Record your measurements.

Ball	Mass / kg	Drop / m	Bounce 1 / m	Bounce 2 / m	Bounce 3 / m	Mean / m
A	0.10	1.00	0.66	0.64	0.65	0.65
B	0.10	1.00	0.80	0.78	0.82	0.80

7 Calculate the two energies, then divide useful output by input.

Ball	Input E_{p1} / J	Useful E_{p2} / J	Efficiency
A	$0.10 \times 9.8 \times 1.00 = 0.98$	$0.10 \times 9.8 \times 0.65 = 0.637$	0.65 (65%)
B	$0.10 \times 9.8 \times 1.00 = 0.98$	$0.10 \times 9.8 \times 0.80 = 0.784$	0.80 (80%)

8 Where did the rest of the energy go?

To the thermal store of the ball and the floor, and some was transferred by sound (ending in the thermal store of the surroundings).

AQA-STYLE

EXAM CORNER

Write in full sentences. Show every step of a calculation.

> **Get the marks:** Check: is your efficiency less than 1 (100%)?

9 A 1200 W hair dryer has a useful power output of 1080 W. Calculate its efficiency as a percentage. **[3 marks]**

EQUATION	$\text{efficiency} = \dfrac{\text{useful power output}}{\text{total power input}}$
SUBSTITUTE	$\dfrac{1080}{1200} = 0.90$ (1)(1)
ANSWER	**90% (1)** unit:

10 Explain why an LED is more efficient than a filament lamp. **[2 marks]**

An LED wastes less energy heating the surroundings (1), so a bigger fraction of the input energy is transferred usefully by light (1).

REVIEW LATER

REVISE IT

Use this box after the lesson and before tests.

SUMMARY

- $\text{efficiency} = \dfrac{\text{useful output}}{\text{total input}}$, using energy or power.
- As a decimal (at most 1) or a percentage (at most 100%). No unit.
- useful = efficiency × total; total = useful ÷ efficiency.
- Sankey diagrams: arrow width shows energy; wasted energy bends away.
- Higher: lubricate, streamline, insulate to increase efficiency.

COVER THE PAGE AND ANSWER

1 Write the equation for efficiency using energy.

2 A device transfers 30 J usefully from 120 J. What is its efficiency?

3 Why can efficiency never be more than 100%?

4 On a Sankey diagram, what does the width of an arrow show?

I CAN...

- calculate efficiency as a decimal and a percentage
- find the useful output or the total input
- draw and read a Sankey diagram
- describe ways to increase efficiency

REFERENCE

KEY WORDS

Learn the meaning and the spelling. In exams, precise words earn marks: say “transferred to the thermal store of the surroundings”, never “lost”.

Energy store L1: Where energy is held. The main stores are kinetic, gravitational potential, elastic potential, thermal and chemical

Joule (J) L1: The unit of energy

System L1: The object or group of objects that we choose to study

Closed system L1: A system that no energy enters or leaves; its total energy stays the same

Kinetic store L2: Energy an object has because it is moving

Gravitational potential store L3: Energy an object has because it is raised in a gravitational field

Gravitational field strength (g) L3: The force of gravity on each kilogram: 9.8 N/kg on Earth

Extension L4: Stretched length minus original length

Spring constant (k) L4: The force needed for each metre of extension, in N/m; a stiffer spring has a bigger k

Elastic deformation L4: The object goes back to its original shape when the force is removed

Inelastic deformation L4: The object stays stretched or bent when the force is removed

Limit of proportionality L4: The point beyond which extension is no longer directly proportional to force

Elastic potential store L5: Energy an object has because it is stretched or squashed

Conservation of energy L6: Energy can be transferred usefully, stored or dissipated, but cannot be created or destroyed

Dissipated L6: Spread out to the surroundings, usually to the thermal store, where it is no longer useful

Power L7: The rate of energy transfer: energy transferred per second

Watt (W) L7: The unit of power: 1 W = 1 J/s

Lubrication L8: Oil or grease between moving parts, to reduce friction

Thermal conductivity L8: How fast a material transfers energy by conduction; higher means faster

Thermal insulator L8: A material with a low thermal conductivity

Efficiency L9: Useful output ÷ total input; a decimal up to 1 or a percentage up to 100%

Sankey diagram L9: A diagram in which the width of each arrow shows the amount of energy

FINISH

PROGRESS TRACKER

Colour one circle for each statement: **red** = not yet, **amber** = getting there, **green** = I can do this without help. Revisit your reds first.

I CAN…	R / A / G
01: Energy stores and systems	
name the energy stores	
name the four ways energy is transferred	
explain what a system is	
describe energy transfers using “from … to …”	
02: The kinetic store	
calculate kinetic energy with $E_k = \frac{1}{2} m v^2$	
convert grams to kilograms	
explain why doubling the speed gives four times the energy	
03: The gravitational potential store	
explain what $g = 9.8$ N/kg means	
calculate $E_p = m g h$ using the height gained	
rearrange $E_p = m g h$ to find a height or a mass	
04: Stretching springs	
explain why two forces are needed to stretch a spring	
calculate an extension from two lengths	
use $F = k e$ and its rearrangements	
plot both graphs and find k from the gradient	
05: The elastic potential store	
calculate $E_e = \frac{1}{2} k e^2$ with the extension in metres	
find k from a force first, then calculate E_e	
explain why doubling the extension gives four times the energy	
06: Conservation of energy	
state the principle of conservation of energy	
use energy lost = energy gained in calculations	

I CAN…	R / A / G
draw energy bar charts	
explain why real systems dissipate energy	
07: Power	
define power as the rate of energy transfer	
calculate $P = \frac{E}{t}$ and find E or t	
convert kW, kJ and minutes	
measure my own power	
08: Wasted energy	
explain what dissipated means	
explain how lubrication reduces wasted energy	
explain the effect of thermal conductivity and wall thickness	
design and justify ways to insulate a home	
09: Efficiency	
calculate efficiency as a decimal and a percentage	
find the useful output or the total input	
draw and read a Sankey diagram	
describe ways to increase efficiency	

CHECK YOURSELF

QUICK ANSWERS

Answers to the “Do now” and “Cover the page” questions, so you can check yourself when revising. Answers to the longer questions are in your teacher's answer edition.

LESSON 1: ENERGY STORES AND SYSTEMS

DO NOW

1. For example, a moving car (it is moving) or a hot drink (it is hot). Any sensible answer.
2. joules (J)
3. Warmer: rubbing (friction) transfers energy to the thermal store of your hands.

COVER THE PAGE

1. Joule (J).
2. Any four of: kinetic, gravitational potential, elastic potential, thermal, chemical.
3. A way of transferring energy (by waves).
4. A system that no energy enters or leaves, so its total energy stays the same.

LESSON 2: THE KINETIC STORE

DO NOW

1. The kinetic store.
2. The thermal store (of the brakes and the surroundings).
3. A way energy is transferred (by waves).

COVER THE PAGE

1. Mass and speed.
2. $E_k = \frac{1}{2}\,m\,v^2$
3. 0.250 kg
4. It becomes 9 times bigger.

LESSON 3: THE GRAVITATIONAL POTENTIAL STORE

DO NOW

1. Speed, in metres per second (m/s).
2. 0.600 kg
3. $E_k = 0.5 \times 2.0 \times 4.0^2$
   $E_k = 16$ J

COVER THE PAGE

1. Gravity pulls each kilogram down with a force of 9.8 N.
2. $E_p = m\,g\,h$
3. 98 J
4. $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$

LESSON 4: STRETCHING SPRINGS

DO NOW

1. Gravitational field strength: 9.8 N/kg.
2. $E_p = 2.0 \times 9.8 \times 3.0$
   $E_p = 58.8$ J
3. 0.12 m

COVER THE PAGE

1. Its stretched length minus its original length.
2. $F = k\,e$
3. Newtons per metre (N/m).
4. The object does not go back to its original shape when the force is removed.

LESSON 5: THE ELASTIC POTENTIAL STORE

DO NOW

1. $F = k\,e = 50 \times 0.10 = 5.0$ N
2. N/m
3. 4

COVER THE PAGE

1. $E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$
2. Metres (m).
3. It becomes 4 times bigger.
4. Beyond the limit of proportionality.

LESSON 6: CONSERVATION OF ENERGY

DO NOW

1. $E_p = 1.0 \times 9.8 \times 2.0$
   $E_p = 19.6$ J
2. $E_k = 0.5 \times 2.0 \times 3.0^2$
   $E_k = 9.0$ J
3. elastic potential

COVER THE PAGE

1. Energy can be transferred usefully, stored or dissipated, but cannot be created or destroyed.
2. 12 J
3. Some energy is dissipated to the thermal store of the surroundings by air resistance and friction.
4. How much energy is in each store at one moment.

LESSON 7: POWER

DO NOW

1. $E_p = 50 \times 9.8 \times 3.0$
   $E_p = 1470$ J
2. 120 s
3. Energy can be transferred usefully, stored or dissipated, but cannot be created or destroyed.

COVER THE PAGE

1. The rate of energy transfer (energy transferred per second).
2. 1 joule per second.
3. 60 W
4. $E = Pt$

LESSON 8: WASTED ENERGY

DO NOW

1. P = 600 ÷ 20 = 30 W
2. thermal
3. Some energy is dissipated by air resistance and friction.

COVER THE PAGE

1. In the thermal store of the surroundings.
2. It reduces friction, so less energy is transferred to the thermal store.
3. The material transfers energy by conduction quickly.
4. Thicker walls; materials with a lower thermal conductivity (insulation).

LESSON 9: EFFICIENCY

DO NOW

1. E = P t = 2000 × 30 = 60 000 J
2. The thermal store of the surroundings.
3. Lubricate it with oil or grease.

COVER THE PAGE

1. efficiency = useful output energy transfer ÷ total input energy transfer
2. 0.25 (25%)
3. Energy cannot be created: the useful output can never be more than the input.
4. The amount of energy.

REFERENCE

EQUATION TOOLKIT

Every equation in the unit. AQA prints all of them on the equation sheet in the exam, but you still need to know what each symbol means, its unit, and how to use it. Use $g = 9.8\ \text{N/kg}$.

1. Cover the quantity you want to find.
2. What is left side by side? **Multiply**.
3. One above the other? **Divide** the top by the bottom.

Example: to find h from $E_p = m\,g\,h$, cover h. E_p is above m and g, so $h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$. Kinetic and elastic potential energy have no triangle: in this unit you only use them to calculate the energy.

$E_k = \frac{1}{2}\,m\,v^2$

Lesson 2

kinetic energy = 0.5 × mass × (speed)²

J, kg, m/s

Use it to calculate the energy. Only the speed is squared.

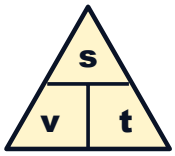
$s = v\,t$

Lesson 2

distance travelled = speed × time

m, m/s, s

$v = \dfrac{s}{t}$ and $t = \dfrac{s}{v}$



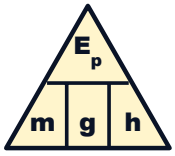
$E_p = m\,g\,h$

Lesson 3

gravitational potential energy = mass × gravitational field strength × height

J, kg, N/kg, m

$h = \dfrac{E_p}{m\,g}$ and $m = \dfrac{E_p}{g\,h}$



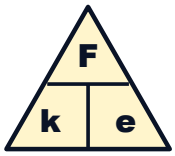
$F = k\,e$

Lesson 4

force = spring constant × extension

N, N/m, m

$k = \dfrac{F}{e}$ and $e = \dfrac{F}{k}$



$E_e = \frac{1}{2}\,k\,e^2$

Lesson 5

elastic potential energy = 0.5 × spring constant × (extension)²

J, N/m, m

Use it to calculate the energy. Only the extension is squared.

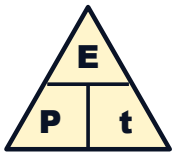
$P = \dfrac{E}{t}$

Lesson 7

power = energy transferred ÷ time

W, J, s

$E = P\,t$ and $t = \dfrac{E}{P}$



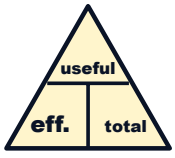
$\text{eff.} = \dfrac{\text{useful output}}{\text{total input}}$

Lesson 9

efficiency = useful output ÷ total input, using energy (J) or power (W)

no unit: a decimal up to 1, or × 100 for a percentage

useful = eff. × total; $\text{total} = \dfrac{\text{useful}}{\text{eff.}}$



1

Write what you know. Convert first: g → kg, cm → m, kJ → J, min → s, % → decimal.

2

Write the equation in symbols.

3

Rearrange if you need to, then substitute the numbers.

4

Give the answer with a unit. Ask: is it sensible?